NATIONAL COMMISSIONS SC ST BC

EVOLUTION FROM SPECIAL OFFICER → COMPOSITION, APPOINTMENT, TENURE AND → COMMON DUTIES AND COMPLAINT-TO-POLICY → CIVIL-COURT POWERS AND REMEDIAL → REPORTS, ACTION MEMORANDA AND → NCSC AND NCST: COMMON

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g3 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 EVOLUTION FROM SPECIAL OFFICER TO THREE COMMISSIONS

EVOLUTION FROM SPECIAL OFFICER TO THREE COMMISSIONS · ORIGINAL ARTICLE 338 · SPECIAL OFFICER FOR SCHEDULED CASTES AND SCHEDULED TRIBES. · 65TH AMENDMENT ACT, 1990 COMBINED NATIONAL COMMISSION FOR SCs · FIRST CONSTITUTIONAL COMMISSION CONSTITUTED 12 MARCH 1992. · 89TH AMENDMENT ACT, 2003 · ARTICLE 338 RETAINED FOR NCSC + ARTICLE 338A INSERTED · SEPARATE COMMISSIONS OPERATIONAL 19 FEBRUARY 2004.

ORIGINAL ARTICLE 338 → Special Officer for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. → 65TH AMENDMENT ACT, 1990 combined National Commission for SCs and STs → first constitutional commission constituted 12 March 1992. → 89TH AMENDMENT ACT, 2003

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ORIGINAL ARTICLE 338
- Special Officer for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.
- 65TH AMENDMENT ACT, 1990 combined National Commission for SCs and STs
- first constitutional commission constituted 12 March 1992.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 89TH AMENDMENT ACT, 2003
- Article 338 retained for NCSC + Article 338A inserted for NCST
- separate commissions operational 19 February 2004.
- Indra Sawhney (1992) → permanent backward-class body.

CHECK / LIMIT
- NCBC Act, 1993 → statutory NCBC.
- 102ND AMENDMENT ACT, 2018
- Article 338B + Article 342A + Article 366(26C)
- constitutional NCBC operational 15 August 2018.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 105TH AMENDMENT ACT, 2021
- State/UT own-list competence made explicit from 15 September 2021.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State/UT own-list competence made explicit from 15 September 2021.

01 STAGE 01 COMPOSITION, APPOINTMENT, TENURE AND PROCEDURE

COMPOSITION, APPOINTMENT, TENURE AND PROCEDURE · COMMON COMPOSITION · CHAIRPERSON + VICE-CHAIRPERSON + THREE OTHER MEMBERS. · PRESIDENT BY WARRANT UNDER HAND AND SEAL. · SERVICE CONDITIONS · TENURE SUBJECT TO PARLIAMENTARY LAW, DETERMINED BY PRESIDENTIAL RULES. · THREE-YEAR TERM COMES FROM GOVERNING RULES, NOT THE CONSTITUTIONAL · PROCEDURE EACH COMMISSION MAY REGULATE ITS OWN PROCEDURE.

COMMON COMPOSITION → Chairperson + Vice-Chairperson + three other Members. → President by warrant under hand and seal. → SERVICE CONDITIONS / TENURE subject to parliamentary law, determined by presidential rules. → Three-year term comes from governing rules, not the constitutional clause itself.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- COMMON COMPOSITION
- Chairperson + Vice-Chairperson + three other Members.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- President by warrant under hand and seal.
- SERVICE CONDITIONS / TENURE subject to parliamentary law, determined by presidential rules.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Three-year term comes from governing rules, not the constitutional clause itself.
- PROCEDURE each Commission may regulate its own procedure.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS entrenches existence, mandate and report route.
- LIMIT constitutional status does not automatically guarantee timely appointments, regional reach, staff capacity, data quality or acceptance of

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT constitutional status does not automatically guarantee timely appointments, regional reach, staff capacity, data quality or acceptance of recommendations.

02 STAGE 02 COMMON DUTIES AND COMPLAINT-TO-POLICY CYCLE

COMMON DUTIES AND COMPLAINT-TO-POLICY CYCLE · COMMON DUTIES UNDER CLAUSE (5) INVESTIGATE AND MONITOR SAFEGUARDS. · INQUIRE INTO SPECIFIC COMPLAINTS OF DEPRIVATION. · PARTICIPATE AND ADVISE IN SOCIO-ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT PLANNING. · EVALUATE DEVELOPMENT PROGRESS. · PRESENT ANNUAL AND OTHER REPORTS TO PRESIDENT. · RECOMMEND MEASURES FOR EFFECTIVE IMPLEMENTATION AND PROTECTION. · PERFORM OTHER SPECIFIED FUNCTIONS.

COMMON DUTIES UNDER CLAUSE (5) investigate and monitor safeguards. → inquire into specific complaints of deprivation. → participate and advise in socio-economic development planning. → evaluate development progress. → present annual and other reports to President.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- COMMON DUTIES UNDER CLAUSE (5) investigate and monitor safeguards.
- inquire into specific complaints of deprivation.
- participate and advise in socio-economic development planning.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- evaluate development progress.
- present annual and other reports to President.
- recommend measures for effective implementation and protection.

CHECK / LIMIT
- perform other specified functions.
- EVIDENCE CYCLE safeguard → implementation record → complaint/monitoring
- inquiry → finding → recommendation → government response

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- legislative scrutiny → corrective law, policy or administration.
- Commission scrutiny supports remedies; it does not replace police, tribunal or court.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commission scrutiny supports remedies; it does not replace police, tribunal or court.

03 STAGE 03 CIVIL-COURT POWERS AND REMEDIAL LIMITS

CIVIL-COURT POWERS AND REMEDIAL LIMITS · IN INVESTIGATION OR INQUIRY SUMMON AND ENFORCE ATTENDANCE · EXAMINE ON OATH REQUIRE DISCOVERY/PRODUCTION · RECEIVE AFFIDAVIT EVIDENCE REQUISITION PUBLIC RECORDS · ISSUE COMMISSIONS PRESCRIBED ADDITIONAL MATTERS. · LIMIT CIVIL-COURT POWERS GATHER EVIDENCE; THEY DO NOT CREATE · REMEDY ROUTE FINDING/RECOMMENDATION · COMPETENT EXECUTIVE, LEGISLATURE, POLICE, TRIBUNAL OR COURT.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- IN INVESTIGATION OR INQUIRY summon and enforce attendance
- examine on oath require discovery/production

POWER / PROCEDURE
- receive affidavit evidence requisition public records
- issue commissions prescribed additional matters.

CHECK / LIMIT
- LIMIT civil-court powers gather evidence
- they do not create ordinary civil jurisdiction, criminal conviction, executable damages or power to invalidate legislation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- REMEDY ROUTE finding/recommendation → competent executive, legislature, police, tribunal or court.
- IN INVESTIGATION OR INQUIRY summon and enforce attendance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REMEDY ROUTE finding/recommendation → competent executive, legislature, police, tribunal or court.

04 STAGE 04 REPORTS, ACTION MEMORANDA AND CONSULTATION

REPORTS, ACTION MEMORANDA AND CONSULTATION · REPORT ROUTE ANNUAL/OTHER REPORT · PARLIAMENT MEMORANDUM ON ACTION TAKEN AND REJECTED ADVICE · STATE-RELATED PART · GOVERNOR/STATE GOVERNMENT · STATE LEGISLATURE + MEMORANDUM. · UNION AND STATE GOVERNMENTS SHALL CONSULT THE RELEVANT COMMISSION · LIMIT CONSULTATION IS A CONSTITUTIONAL HEARING/ACCOUNTABILITY DUTY, NOT A

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- REPORT ROUTE annual/other report → President → Parliament memorandum on action taken and rejected advice.
- State-related part → Governor/State Government → State legislature + memorandum.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Union and State governments shall consult the relevant Commission on major policy matters affecting the protected class.
- LIMIT consultation is a constitutional hearing/accountability duty, not a veto.

CHECK / LIMIT
- REPORT ROUTE annual/other report → President → Parliament memorandum on action taken and rejected advice.
- State-related part → Governor/State Government → State legislature + memorandum.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Union and State governments shall consult the relevant Commission on major policy matters affecting the protected class.
- LIMIT consultation is a constitutional hearing/accountability duty, not a veto.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT consultation is a constitutional hearing/accountability duty, not a veto.

05 STAGE 05 NCSC AND NCST: COMMON ENGINE, DISTINCT DOMAINS

NCSC AND NCST · COMMON ENGINE, DISTINCT DOMAINS · ARTICLE 338 · SC SAFEGUARDS. UNTOUCHABILITY, REPRESENTATION, SERVICE DISCRIMINATION AND ATROCITY-PREVENTION IMPLEMENTATION. · ARTICLE 338A · ST SAFEGUARDS PLUS TRIBAL LAND, FOREST, MINOR PRODUCE, DISPLACEMENT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
NCSC: ARTICLE 338 SC safeguards; untouchability, representation, service discrimination and atrocity-prevention implementation.	NCST: ARTICLE 338A ST safeguards plus tribal land, forest, minor produce, displacement, resources, PESA and shifting-cultivation concerns under specified functions.	NCSC: ARTICLE 338 SC safeguards; untouchability, representation, service discrimination and atrocity-prevention implementation.	NCST: ARTICLE 338A ST safeguards plus tribal land, forest, minor produce, displacement, resources, PESA and shifting-cultivation concerns under specified functions.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- NCSC: ARTICLE 338
- SC safeguards; untouchability, representation, service discrimination and atrocity-prevention implementation.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- NCST: ARTICLE 338A
- ST safeguards plus tribal land, forest, minor produce, displacement, resources, PESA and shifting-cultivation concerns under specified functions.

CHECK / LIMIT
- NCSC: ARTICLE 338
- SC safeguards; untouchability, representation, service discrimination and atrocity-prevention implementation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- NCSC: ARTICLE 338A
- ST safeguards plus tribal land, forest, minor produce, displacement, resources, PESA and shifting-cultivation concerns under specified functions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ST safeguards plus tribal land, forest, minor produce, displacement, resources, PESA and shifting-cultivation concerns under specified functions.

06 STAGE 06 NCBC CONSTITUTIONALISATION AND SAFEGUARD ROLE

NCBC CONSTITUTIONALISATION AND SAFEGUARD ROLE · ARTICLE 338B · 102ND AMENDMENT, 2018 TRANSFORMED THE 1993 STATUTORY NCBC INTO · COMMON ENGINE MONITOR SAFEGUARDS · DEVELOPMENT ADVICE/EVALUATION REPORTS · SPECIFIED ADDITIONAL FUNCTIONS. · CONSULTATION MAJOR SEBC POLICY MATTERS, SUBJECT TO THE ARTICLE · NCBC ADVICE DOES NOT ITSELF AMEND THE CENTRAL OR

NCBC- ARTICLE 338B

102nd Amendment, 2018 transformed the 1993 statutory NCBC into a constitutional safeguard commission. → COMMON ENGINE monitor safeguards → development advice/evaluation reports

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- NCBC: ARTICLE 338B
- 102nd Amendment, 2018 transformed the 1993 statutory NCBC into a constitutional safeguard commission.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- COMMON ENGINE monitor safeguards
- development advice/evaluation reports

CHECK / LIMIT
- specified additional functions.
- CONSULTATION major SEBC policy matters, subject to the Article 338B(9) exception for State/UT own-list preparation under Article 342A(3).

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- NCBC advice does not itself amend the Central or a State SEBC list.
- NCBC: ARTICLE 338B

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NCBC advice does not itself amend the Central or a State SEBC list.

07 STAGE 07 SC, ST AND SEBC LIST-AMENDMENT AUTHORITIES

SC, ST AND SEBC LIST-AMENDMENT AUTHORITIES · SCHEDULED CASTES · ARTICLE 341 · PRESIDENT SPECIFIES BY PUBLIC NOTIFICATION FOR A STATE/UT · PARLIAMENT LATER INCLUDES OR EXCLUDES BY LAW. · SCHEDULED TRIBES · ARTICLE 342 SAME CONSTITUTIONAL PATTERN; STATE CONSULTATION OCCURS AT · SEBC CENTRAL LIST

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- SCHEDULED CASTES: ARTICLE 341
- President specifies by public notification for a State/UT
- Parliament later includes or excludes by law.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SCHEDULED TRIBES: ARTICLE 342 same constitutional pattern; State consultation occurs at initial specification.
- SEBC CENTRAL LIST: ARTICLE 342A(1)-(2)
- President specifies for Central Government purposes

CHECK / LIMIT
- Parliament includes or excludes by law.
- STATE / UT LIST: ARTICLE 342A(3)
- State or UT may by law prepare and maintain its own list for own purposes.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ARTICLE 366(26C) defines socially and educationally backward classes through Article 342A.
- CORE DISTINCTION
- Commission advice informs process; the constitutionally named authority changes legal status.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commission advice informs process; the constitutionally named authority changes legal status.

08 STAGE 08 102ND, MARATHA JUDGMENT AND 105TH AMENDMENT

102ND, MARATHA JUDGMENT AND 105TH AMENDMENT · 102ND AMENDMENT, 2018 CONSTITUTIONAL NCBC + ORIGINAL ARTICLE 342A · JAISHRI LAXMANRAO PATIL (2021) MAJORITY READ THE 102ND AMENDMENT · THE MARATHA QUOTA ALSO FAILED THE SEPARATE 50% CEILING · 105TH AMENDMENT, 2021 · CENTRAL LIST CONFINED TO CENTRAL PURPOSES · STATE/UT OWN LISTS EXPRESSLY RESTORED/CLARIFIED IN ARTICLE 342A(3) · ARTICLE 338B(9) CONSULTATION EXCEPTION FOR THAT LIST-MAKING PURPOSE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 102ND AMENDMENT, 2018 constitutional NCBC + original Article 342A list wording.
- Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil (2021) majority read the 102nd Amendment as displacing independent State SEBC identification
- the Maratha quota also failed the separate 50% ceiling analysis.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 105TH AMENDMENT, 2021
- Central List confined to Central purposes
- State/UT own lists expressly restored/clarified in Article 342A(3)

CHECK / LIMIT
- Article 338B(9) consultation exception for that list-making purpose.
- TRAP reservation ceiling, identification authority and Commission consultation are separate constitutional questions.
- LIMIT the 105th Amendment did not itself decide every quota, inclusion or creamy-layer dispute.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 105TH AMENDMENT, 2021

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP reservation ceiling, identification authority and Commission consultation are separate constitutional questions.

09 STAGE 09 DAVINDER SINGH (2024) AND EVIDENCE-BASED SC SUB-CLASSIFICATION

DAVINDER SINGH (2024) AND EVIDENCE-BASED SC SUB-CLASSIFICATION · DAVINDER SINGH (2024) · STATES MAY CREATE EVIDENCE-BASED SUB-CLASSIFICATION WITHIN SCHEDULED CASTES TO · CONDITIONS QUANTIFIABLE AND DEMONSTRABLE MATERIAL · RATIONAL CLASSIFICATION · NO DELETION FROM OR ALTERATION OF THE ARTICLE 341 · JUDICIAL REVIEW REMAINS. · OVERRULED BOUNDARY

Davinder Singh (2024)

States may create evidence-based sub-classification within Scheduled Castes to distribute reservation benefits more equitably. → CONDITIONS quantifiable and demonstrable material → rational classification → no deletion from or alteration of the Article 341 Presidential List

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Davinder Singh (2024)
- States may create evidence-based sub-classification within Scheduled Castes to distribute reservation benefits more equitably.
- CONDITIONS quantifiable and demonstrable material → rational classification

POWER / PROCEDURE
- no deletion from or alteration of the Article 341 Presidential List
- judicial review remains.
- OVERRULED BOUNDARY

CHECK / LIMIT
- E.V. Chinnaiah was overruled on the bar against SC sub-classification.
- CREAMY-LAYER CAUTION separate judicial opinions discussed exclusion ideas
- do not present them as one unanimous, enacted SC/ST creamy-layer rule.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- COMMISSION ROLE evidence, consultation and monitoring may inform policy but do not replace valid law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: do not present them as one unanimous, enacted SC/ST creamy-layer rule.

10 STAGE 10 OVERLAP, INDEPENDENCE, CAPACITY AND COORDINATED REFORM

OVERLAP, INDEPENDENCE, CAPACITY AND COORDINATED REFORM · GAPS VACANCIES · REGIONAL ACCESS · COMPLAINT DELAY · WEAK DATA DELAYED REPORTS/RESPONSES · OVERLAPPING FORUMS · ADVISORY LIMITS. · REFORM TRANSPARENT APPOINTMENTS + TIMELY STAFFING + COMMON INTAKE/REFERRAL

GAPS vacancies → regional access → complaint delay → weak data delayed reports/responses → overlapping forums

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- GAPS vacancies
- regional access
- complaint delay

POWER / PROCEDURE
- weak data delayed reports/responses
- overlapping forums
- advisory limits.

CHECK / LIMIT
- REFORM transparent appointments + timely staffing + common intake/referral
- joint inquiry protocols + public recommendation tracker
- research/data capacity + reasoned action memoranda.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- DESIGN VERDICT coordinate specialised commissions; do not erase distinct SC, ST and SEBC safeguards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DESIGN VERDICT coordinate specialised commissions; do not erase distinct SC, ST and SEBC safeguards.

11 STAGE 11 PYQ ROUTES, PRELIMS TRAPS AND MAINS SYNTHESIS

PYQ ROUTES, PRELIMS TRAPS AND MAINS SYNTHESIS · IMPLEMENTATION GAPS VACANCIES + DELAYED REPORTS + WEAK REGIONAL · REFORM TRANSPARENT APPOINTMENTS · TIME-BOUND STAFFING · COMMON INTAKE/REFERRAL · JOINT INQUIRY PROTOCOL · PUBLIC ACTION-TAKEN DASHBOARD · RESEARCH CAPACITY

IMPLEMENTATION GAPS vacancies + delayed reports + weak regional access + fragmented complaint data poor → REFORM transparent appointments → time-bound staffing → common intake/referral → joint inquiry protocol → public action-taken dashboard → research capacity → reasoned government response. → PRELIMS FIREWALL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- IMPLEMENTATION GAPS vacancies + delayed reports + weak regional access + fragmented complaint data poor recommendation tracking + overlapping forums.
- REFORM transparent appointments → time-bound staffing → common intake/referral
- joint inquiry protocol → public action-taken dashboard
- research capacity → reasoned government response.
- PRELIMS FIREWALL

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 338A NCST
- 338B NCBC
- Chair + Vice-Chair + three Members civil-court powers only for inquiry
- recommendations generally advisory
- 341 SC

CHECK / LIMIT
- 342A Central/State SEBC architecture.
- PYQ ROUTES
- 2018 NCSC/minority reservation + umbrella commission
- 2020 constitutionalisation
- 2022 NCBC

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 2024 ST list
- MAINS SPINE constitutional purpose → common powers → distinct domain → legal limit
- case/amendment → implementation gap → coordinated-specialisation verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAINS SPINE constitutional purpose → common powers → distinct domain → legal limit.

E EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE BIG PICTURE · PART A — NCSC (ART 338) & NCST (ART · PART B — NCBC (ART 338-B) · PART C — LINGUISTIC MINORITIES (ART 350-B) · COMPOSITION (EACH) · CHAIRPERSON + VICE-CHAIRPERSON + 3 MEMBERS , APPOINTED BY · INVESTIGATE/MONITOR SC/ST SAFEGUARDS; INQUIRE INTO COMPLAINTS; ADVISE ON &

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- THE BIG PICTURE
- PART A — NCSC (Art 338) & NCST (Art 338-A)
- PART B — NCBC (Art 338-B)
- PART C — LINGUISTIC MINORITIES (Art 350-B)

ADVANCED LIMIT
- Composition (each): Chairperson + Vice-Chairperson + 3 members , appointed by the President by
- Functions: investigate/monitor SC/ST safeguards; inquire into complaints; advise on & evaluate
- Civil-court powers while investigating (summon persons, require documents, receive affidavit evidence,
- NCST extra duties (tribal-specific): safeguards under forest/mining law, minor forest produce, PESA/FRA

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- Composition: Chairperson + Vice-Chairperson + 3 members (President-appointed).
- Centre & states must consult the NCBC on all major policy matters affecting SEBCs.
- CAUTION: 105th Amendment (2021): restored states'/UTs' power to make their own SEBC/OBC lists (after the SC's
- Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities , appointed by the President → investigates safeguards for

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels